

ANIL KUMAR PATHAK

PLANT OPERATIONS LEADER | DAIRY & FOOD MANUFACTURING

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An enterprising professional and visionary leader offering multi-faceted expertise in **Plant Operations Management** and **Dairy & Food Manufacturing**; targeting to express potential and deliver results through **strategic leadership assignments** with an organization of repute

Core Competencies

Strategic Planning & Leadership

Plant Operations Management

Dairy & Food Manufacturing

Technology Transfer & Scale-Up

Process Validation & Optimization

Greenfield Project Execution

Equipment Qualification

Production Planning & Control

Team Building & Mentoring

Vendor Development

Cross-functional Collaboration

Achievements



Supervised **installation, repair, and maintenance of mechanical systems**, integrating **Kaizen, 5S, and Lean/TPM** practices to drive **continuous improvement**.



Guided the **Plant Executive Committee** with strategic insights to address **operational challenges** and resolve **product technical issues** effectively.



Deployed **QbD tools** including **QTPP, CMA, CPP** in **product development**, recommending changes to enhance **efficacy, quality, and regulatory compliance**.



Scheduled **preventive maintenance** for key **machinery and equipment**, improving **machine uptime** and exceeding rated **plant capacity** while enhancing **yield and product quality**.



Developed and nurtured a **talent pipeline** by mentoring and training **management staff and shop-floor personnel**, ensuring future **workforce competency and retention**.

Profile Summary

- Brings **over 30 years of leadership experience** in managing end-to-end operations of large-scale **dairy and food manufacturing facilities**, with a focus on **plant efficiency, regulatory compliance, and technology-driven production systems**.
- Adept at driving **multi-product plant operations** across India and Africa, with significant exposure to **fresh milk, market milk, fermented dairy products (yogurt, lassi, smoothie), juices, ice-cream, butter, ghee, milk evaporators and dryers (various dairy milk powders), retort, UHT milk, non-dairy creamers, and excluded snacks (maize, rice, pulses)**.
- Managed end-to-end bottling line operations on **Filmatic bottle filling line systems at 150 BPM and 300 BPM**, handling **manual and automatic feeding, ozonated rinsing, hot filling, aluminium foil sealing, capping, cooling, labeling/sleeving, wrapping, and complete line sanitization** for hot fill dairy beverages and juices packaged in **HDPE and PET bottles**.
- Recognized for leading **greenfield projects** and taking them from conceptual design through **commissioning and scale-up**, ensuring that all critical milestones including equipment qualification, productivity ramp-up, and regulatory audit.
- Demonstrates mastery in implementing **FSSC 22000, EMS ISO-50001, HSE ISO-45001, Lean Manufacturing, GMP, TPM, Kaizen, and QbD** frameworks to **operational productivity, reduce cost per unit, and enhance product yield**, surpassing production targets.
- Proven ability to align **cross-functional teams**—including Quality, Procurement, Engineering, R&D, and SCM—towards a unified production roadmap, leading to optimized resource utilization and synchronized workflows across the value chain.
- Strategically minded in **production planning and material flow**, with solid exposure to **SAP PP module and ERP systems**, enabling real-time visibility, accurate forecasting, and agility in response to market demands or supply chain disruptions.
- Brings exceptional expertise in **technology transfer, process validation, and equipment qualification**, facilitating smooth handovers from development to commercial production.
- People-oriented leader** with skills in leading and motivating high-performing teams towards the accomplishment of common goals.

Career Timeline (Recent 5 Assignments)

2004-10	2010-11	2011-15	2015-23	2023 – Now
Ste. Mafricom Sarl. Manager - Production	Dwarka Group of Companies Plant Manager (AGM)	Parag Milk Foods Pvt. Ltd. Deputy General Manager	Dairy Gold Ltd. Plant Manager	Africa Snacks SARL General Manager, Plant Operations

Work Experience

Africa Snacks SARL, RDC | Oct'2023 Onwards | **General Manager, Plant Operations**

Directing **end-to-end plant operations** for a multi-product facility producing **fermented dairy products, fruit-based beverages, and maize-based snacks**, ensuring alignment with business goals and compliance with food safety standards.

Dairy Gold Ltd., Lusaka Zambia | Mar'2015 – Sep'2023 | **Plant Manager**

Subsidiary of Trade King Groups | Led operations at a high-capacity facility producing **fermented maize drinks (Maheu) and drinking yoghurt (handling 450,000 litres/day)**, as well as a **non-dairy creamer drying unit with a capacity of 15 MT/day**.

Technical Skills

Hot Filling & Beverage Packaging Equipment

- Unscrambler, Ozonator
- Rotary Rinser, Rotary Gravity Bottle Fillers (300 BPM)
- Bottle Cappers
- Sleeve Applicators
- Case Packers
- Shrink Wrappers
- UHT Sterilizers
- Tetra Pak Aseptic Machines (Bricks & Fino Packing Machines)

Pasteurizers, Separators, Evaporators, Dryers

- Alfa Laval pasteurizers, separators, evaporators
- Spray Dryers with centrifugal spinning disc atomizer & FBD
- SSP Dryer (Stanco Design)
- Seppo Rally evaporators
- Damrow spray driers with FBD
- Barr & Murphy Ring Dryer

Powder & Liquid Filling Lines

- Powder Packing: FFS Machines (Nichrome, Hassia, Rollainers)
- Jar Filling Machine: Panchal
- Ghee Filling Machines:
 - Rollainers for CEKA
 - Mathe Platt (500g–5kg)
 - Avery (15kg tins)
 - Nichrome Fill-Pack (pouches)

Separation & Filtration Systems

- Westfalia Separators (Self-Cleaning & Bactofuges)
- Westphalia Decanters (Casein Curd Separation)
- Ultra Filtration Plant: Membrane System Specialist, USA

Butter, Ghee & Powder Packaging: Specialized packaging lines for butter, ghee (in jars, tins, pouches) and dairy powders

Certifications

Lean Six Sigma Black Belt Certified
CSSC (Council for Six Sigma Certification), USA
Grade A+ | 2023

Parag Milk Foods Ltd., Palamaner, AP | Jul'2011 – Mar'2015
Deputy General Manager – Manufacturing

Oversaw end-to-end operations at a facility with **800,000 litres/day** milk handling capacity, producing **UHT milk, butter, ghee, milk powders, curd, and yogurt**

Key Result Areas across designations

- Spearheading comprehensive **plant operations**, including **production planning**, **resource allocation**, and **quality assurance**, to ensure seamless workflows and alignment with **organizational objectives**.
- Introducing and implementing advanced **production methodologies** and **technologies** to enhance **operational efficiency**, increase **product quality**, and support innovation.
- Collaborating with **cross-functional teams** to design and execute strategic **production plans** and optimize **resource utilization** in line with **market demand** and business goals.
- Establishing and sustaining rigorous **quality control systems**, incorporating **regulatory standards**, **customer expectations**, and **statistical tools** to monitor output.
- Spearheading **continuous improvement initiatives** using **Lean Manufacturing**, **TPM**, **QMS**, and efficiency-driven methodologies to reduce **waste** and improve overall performance.
- Evaluating **performance metrics**, identifying process bottlenecks, and applying **corrective actions** to optimize **productivity** and ensure consistent results.
- Leading **cross-functional project teams**, aligning new initiatives with operational capacity and **strategic objectives** to ensure timely, high-quality execution.
- Reviewing and approving essential documentation such as **Validation Master Plans** and **FMEAs**, ensuring adherence to **industry regulations** and internal standards.
- Developing and maintaining **preventive maintenance** programs to maximize **equipment reliability**, minimize downtime, and support uninterrupted production.
- Delivering targeted **training and development programs** to enhance employee **skills**, drive **engagement**, and ensure a high-performing, **capable workforce**.
- Coordinating with **vendors** and managing **supply chain logistics** to maintain optimal **inventory levels** and support production without delays.
- Promoting a culture of **continuous improvement** by encouraging employee participation in **quality circles**, **process enhancement efforts**, and innovation-driven change.

Highlights

- Conceptualized a **new manufacturing plant** for a **regulated market** by completing critical **equipment qualifications & regulatory documentation**, achieving **optimum productivity**.
- Directed **budget planning**, monitored **daily operational reports**, and assessed KPIs, while ensuring compliance with **safety norms**, **SHE policies**, and managing **market complaints**, **change controls**, and **risk assessments**.
- Contributed to successful **audit readiness** by actively participating in all **compliance initiatives** and maintaining adherence to **regulatory standards**.
- Supported **shop-floor operations** during **product transfers** from **R&D to manufacturing**, facilitating **process optimization** and smooth **technology handover**.
- Delivered a **110% increase in sales** during tenure at **Africa Snacks SARL**, driving market expansion and operational excellence in the **RTD (Ready-to-Drink)** segment.
- Spearheaded operations across **8 high-speed bottling lines**, including **Phlematic systems** running at **300 BPM and 150 BPM**, aligning performance with international standards.
- Managed bottling formats across **200ml to 500ml** range, including **HDPE** and **PET bottles**, ensuring product integrity, packaging consistency, and compliance with quality norms.
- Oversaw the production of **long-life oat-fill drinking yogurt**, leveraging specialized filling technology for **HDPE** and **PET formats**, maintaining extended shelf life and flavor stability.

Previous Experience

Dwarka Group of Companies, Wardha | Apr'2010 – Jul'2011 | Assistant General Manager
Managed daily operations of a **fresh milk production facility** with capacity of **200,000 liters/day**

Ste. Mafricom Sarl., Kinshasa | Jan'2004 – Jan'2010

Led operations at a **25,000 liters/ day dairy facility** focused on manufacturing **drinking yogurts** under the **Energy brand**, **fruit-flavored bases**, and **fruit yogurt** for internal consumption. Oversaw **production planning**, **quality control**, **commissioning**, and **team development**.

Highlights

- Commissioned a new production line for **cultured dairy products** (25 MT/day) in Jan 2004, playing a critical role in **erection and ramp-up**, ensuring full operational readiness.
- Exceeded production targets and improved **operational productivity** through **process optimization** and **efficiency standards**.

Education

- 2014 | **MBA in Production and Operations**
SMU
- 2002 | **Completed 6 Months course on TPM**
Faculty from the Institute of JMAM, Delhi
- 1994 | **B.Tech. (Dairy Technology)**
College of Dairy Technology, Raipur, I.G. Agriculture University

Personal Details

Date of Birth: 1st August 1969

Languages Address: English, Hindi, French, Telugu

Address: House. No. 411, Phase-3 Garden Home Alkapuri, Behind New High Court City Center Gwalior (M.P.) – 474 011

- Established robust **quality and hygiene protocols**, elevating **product consistency** and aligning with **international food safety norms**.
- Formulated an in-house **flavored syrup base** for drinking yogurt, enabling internal material use and achieving a **50% cost reduction**.

Dynamix Dairy Industries Ltd. | Jul'2001 – Jan'2004

A fully automated, PLC-operated dairy plant with 1 million liters'/day capacity, producing diverse dairy and food products for global clients including Nestlé, Britannia, Tropicana, Domino's Pizza, Pizza Hut, McDonald's, and Schreiber Foods (USA).

Growth Path

Jul'2001 – Jan'2002 | **Assistant Production Manager**

Feb'2002 – Jan'2004 | **Manager (Production)**

Highlights

- Exceeded production targets by consistently delivering **100%+ output**, supporting high-volume demand from multinational clients.
- Achieved a **95% increase in overall productivity** by optimizing **process workflows**.
- Reduced **power & fuel consumption** by ensuring **100% resource capacity utilization**.
- Managed large-scale production of **UHT milk, natural and processed cheese, dairy powders (SMP, WMP, dairy whitener)**, and **value-added by-products** such as **casein powder, whey protein, WPC (40 & 80)**, and **lactose powder**: cream, butter, ghee, dahi, juices, and flavored milk beverages.
- Progressed from **Assistant Production Manager to Production Manager** within 7 months.

JK Dairy & Foods Ltd. (Now Umang Dairy) | Aug'1996 – Jul'2001

Growth Path:

Aug'1996 – Jun'1999 | **Executive (Production)**

Jul'1999 – Jul'2001 | **Senior Executive (Production)**

Highlights:

- Handled plant operations with a capacity of **350,000 liters/day**.
- Managed end-to-end processing of **milk powder, ghee, butter**, and **cream**.

Milk Specialties Ltd., Derbassi, Punjab | Mar'1995 – Aug'1996 | **Executive (Production)**

Highlights:

- Managed operations of a **dairy processing plant** with a capacity of **350,000 liters/day**.
- Drove production of **fresh milk, flavored milk, dairy milk (SMP, WMP, Dairy Whitener)**, **butter**, and **ghee**.